

02-10-2026 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9l9Yc9bn19w
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Target Category	mcs

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presided over by President Williams. Meeting of the Muncie Community Schools board.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** President Williams, Mrs. Barnes, Griffin, Mr. Urban, Mr. Low.
 - **Absent:** Mr. Heater.
 - **Presiding Officer:** President Williams.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Opening moment of silence and joint recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Approval of Minutes:** *(Not explicitly detailed in the transcript text).*

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **01:14:51 Consent Items & Donations**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Administration.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Recognition of donations made to the Panther Pantry (from Pam Gillan, Brian and Sarah Fox, Northwest Bank, and Martha Song) and to Central Boys Basketball.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **01:15:42 High School Curriculum Handbook**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Grim / Mr. Walker.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation of the 141-page high school curriculum handbook with minor revisions for the year. Notable updates include the removal of a Purdue course due to university cuts, course name updates aligning with IDOE guidelines, terminology updates (e.g., Indiana College Core), and graduation Latin honor ribbon updates (white for cum laude, silver for magna cum laude, gold for summa cum laude).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **01:20:31 Resolution / Permission to Advertise Additional Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome / Mr. Brad.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for board permission to advertise for a public hearing (scheduled for March 17, with an ad running March 4) regarding an additional appropriation of \$300,000. Staff clarified that these are projected interest earnings on funds from an existing bond issue<U+2014>not new debt or tax rate increases<U+2014>directed toward the \$19.8 million deferred maintenance project, specifically heating and cooling upgrades for the Muncie Fieldhouse.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Permission to advertise granted).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:09:42 Rick Yenser** (Newsman and Author)
 - **Topics Addressed:** Inquired about school policies and student rights regarding a recent student walkout/protest (referencing the *Tinker* case and noting roughly 40-45 students peacefully marching to City Hall); questioned funding details regarding fieldhouse bonds and additional appropriations; and voiced broad concerns regarding state and federal legislative impacts on public education funding.
 - **Board Response:** Board members and administrators clarified that unexcused absences for off-campus protests still permit students to make up schoolwork; the \$300,000 appropriation involves interest earnings on existing bonds rather than new borrowing; and board leadership echoed concerns regarding state legislation (such as Senate Enrolled Act 1) and federal policy shifts impacting public education.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Administrative reports covered Black History Month activities, student essay winners (with Michaela Gibson scheduled to read her essay at the February 24 board meeting), and winter athletic updates.
 - School presentations were delivered by Grissom Elementary (highlighting attendance, behavior intervention protocols, and common formative assessments) and Forest Academy / Camp Adventure (highlighting nature-based, Montessori-inspired preschool and kindergarten progress).
 - Upcoming public hearing scheduled for March 17.
- **Adjournment:** Official adjournment by voice vote at the conclusion of the meeting [01:26:15](#).

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